

Japan train cheat sheet

One page: IC rules, train types, and how to read a platform without panic.

IC card basics

- ☐ Tap in at your start station, tap out at exit. One card per person.
- ☐ If the gate flashes red, step back and try again. Staff windows fix most errors fast.
- ☐ Charge at ticket machines or in your phone wallet before peak commute.

Train names you will see

- ☐ Local: every stop. Rapid: skips some. Express: fewer stops. Limited Express: often reserved seats.
- ☐ Shinkansen is separate tickets or pass rules. Do not board the wrong car type on purpose.
- ☐ If unsure, take Local one stop past your mistake, then cross platform. Staff help when you ask.

Platform screen in 10 seconds

- ☐ Departure time, line name, and destination column must match your map app suggestion.
- ☐ Car numbers matter on Shinkansen. Match the platform paint marks to your car.
- ☐ Yellow tactile strips mark queue lines. Stand behind them until the train stops.

Etiquette that saves stress

- ☐ Phone on silent, no voice calls in the car. Bags on rack or between knees, not the aisle.
- ☐ Priority seats: yield when car is crowded even if nobody is standing yet.
- ☐ Do not block doors while others exit. Step off, stand aside, then reboard if changing cars.